

Project Management Plan

PeopleFirst Employee Self-Service Portal

Portfolio Project – Simulated Business Case

Document Control

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Prepared By	Karthick BK
Reviewed By	Ananya Rao
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1. Purpose

The purpose of this Project Management Plan is to define the overall framework for planning, executing, monitoring, controlling, governing, and closing the PeopleFirst Employee Self-Service Portal project.

The plan integrates the project's key management approaches, baselines, governance arrangements, and subsidiary plans and provides the framework for managing the project throughout its lifecycle.

2. Project Overview

PeopleFirst Inc. is undertaking the Employee Experience Platform project to modernize its existing leave-management process, which currently relies on spreadsheets, email-based approvals, and manual reporting. The current process contributes to processing delays, errors, limited visibility, and reduced auditability.

The project will deliver a secure web-based Leave Management solution providing employee self-service, manager approval workflows, HR administration, reporting, notifications, role-based access, auditability, and required enterprise integrations.

The expected outcome is a more efficient, transparent, and controlled leave-management process that improves the employee and manager experience while providing HR with improved administration, reporting, and oversight.

The project will be delivered during the approved August 2026–January 2027 project window using a hybrid delivery approach combining predictive project governance with iterative/Scrum-based solution delivery. The approved project budget is \$420,000.

Detailed project authorization, high-level scope, deliverables, milestones, assumptions, risks, stakeholders, and success criteria are defined in the Project Charter.

3. Project Objectives and Success Criteria

Project Objectives

- Deliver a secure, web-based Leave Management solution that enables employee self-service, manager approvals, HR administration, reporting, notifications, and required enterprise integrations.
- Improve the employee and manager experience by replacing manual and email-based leave-management activities with streamlined digital workflows.
- Reduce manual administrative effort and improve the accuracy, transparency, auditability, and reporting of leave-management activities.
- Deliver the solution within the approved project schedule, targeting production go-live in January 2027.
- Deliver the project within the approved budget of \$420,000.
- Complete required testing, security validation, business acceptance, production deployment, operational handover, and project closure activities.

Success Criteria

The project will be considered successfully delivered and closed when:

- approved scope and required solution capabilities have been delivered;
- required enterprise integrations have been implemented and validated;
- applicable SIT, security, performance, and other required validation activities have been completed in accordance with defined exit criteria;
- UAT has been successfully completed and formal business acceptance obtained;
- production-readiness criteria have been satisfied and the solution successfully deployed to production;
- required project, technical, user, support, and operational documentation and knowledge transfer have been completed and accepted;
- outstanding defects, risks, issues, and actions have been resolved, accepted, or formally transferred to the appropriate owner;
- project financial and schedule performance has been assessed against the approved baselines; and
- project closure and final acceptance have been completed in accordance with project governance requirements.

4. Scope Management

The project scope will be managed against the approved Project Charter, requirements baseline, and associated scope and requirements artifacts.

Scope management will include:

- defining and progressively elaborating detailed requirements within the boundaries of the approved project scope;
- maintaining traceability between approved requirements, delivery work items, testing, and acceptance;
- validating completed deliverables against approved requirements and acceptance criteria;
- monitoring delivery to identify potential scope gaps, omissions, or scope creep;
- assessing proposed scope changes for impact on schedule, cost, resources, quality, risk, and dependencies before approval; and
- managing approved changes through the established change-control process and updating affected baselines and project artifacts.

The Project Manager will coordinate scope management and change control. The Product Owner/Business Lead and Business Analyst will support requirements clarification and business acceptance, while technical stakeholders will assess solution and delivery impacts where applicable.

Changes affecting approved scope, budget, contractual commitments, or key project baselines will require formal assessment and approval through the project's change-control process. Clarifications or refinements that remain within approved scope and do not materially affect established baselines may be managed through normal backlog and delivery activities.

Detailed in-scope and out-of-scope boundaries are maintained in the Project Charter and applicable requirements documentation.

5. Delivery Approach and Lifecycle

The project will use a hybrid delivery approach combining predictive project governance with iterative Scrum-based solution delivery.

Predictive practices will be used to establish and manage the overall project scope, schedule, budget, governance, risks, dependencies, quality expectations, stakeholder communications, change control, and major project milestones.

Solution development will be delivered iteratively through sprints. The Scrum delivery cycle will include backlog refinement, sprint planning, development and testing, daily coordination, sprint review, and retrospective activities. Requirements and acceptance criteria will be progressively clarified and prioritized through the product backlog within the boundaries of the approved project scope.

The Project Manager will also perform the Scrum Master role, coordinating overall project management and governance while facilitating Scrum activities and supporting the delivery team in identifying and resolving impediments.

Quality activities will be integrated throughout iterative delivery, including requirements clarification, technical reviews, code review, unit testing, functional and integration testing, defect resolution, and Definition of Done checks. Following iterative development, the integrated solution will progress through applicable release-level validation, including SIT, security and performance validation, UAT, production readiness, deployment, and handover.

Project lifecycle progression will be governed through existing milestones, readiness reviews, and applicable quality gates rather than through separate parallel governance processes.

6. Schedule Management

The project schedule will be managed through the Integrated Project Schedule, which will serve as the primary schedule baseline and control mechanism for planning, monitoring, and coordinating project activities.

Schedule management will include:

- defining and maintaining project activities, milestones, dependencies, sequencing, and target dates;
- aligning iterative/Scrum delivery activities with overall project milestones and lifecycle commitments;
- monitoring actual progress against planned dates and identifying schedule variances, slippage, and emerging constraints;
- reviewing dependencies, resource availability, risks, issues, and external activities that may affect scheduled work;
- maintaining appropriate schedule contingency/buffers around significant delivery and readiness activities;
- forecasting the impact of delays or changes on downstream activities and key milestones;
- implementing recovery or corrective actions where practical; and
- managing material changes to approved schedule commitments through the established change-control process.

The Project Manager will maintain and monitor the Integrated Project Schedule and coordinate schedule updates with activity owners and relevant stakeholders. Individual work-item and sprint progress may be managed through the team's delivery tool, with significant impacts reflected in the Integrated Project Schedule.

Schedule performance and significant variances will be communicated through existing project status reporting and governance mechanisms. Schedule risks or delays threatening key milestones, dependencies, UAT, go-live, or project completion will be escalated as appropriate.

Detailed activities, dates, dependencies, milestones, resource assignments, and schedule assumptions are maintained in the Integrated Project Schedule and Schedule Basis rather than duplicated in this plan.

7. Cost Management

The project budget will be managed against the approved cost baseline, with expenditure and forecasts monitored throughout the project lifecycle.

Cost management will include:

- monitoring actual and committed costs against the approved budget;
- reviewing forecast costs and estimated cost to complete;

- identifying and assessing cost variances and emerging budget pressures;
- considering the cost impact of scope changes, schedule changes, resource requirements, risks, issues, and corrective actions;
- implementing appropriate corrective actions where cost performance is at risk; and
- managing material changes to the approved budget through the established change-control process.

The Project Manager will coordinate cost monitoring and reporting with the Delivery Manager and other appropriate stakeholders. Cost information will be reviewed at appropriate project reporting and governance points, with significant variances or forecast overruns escalated for management attention and decision.

The approved project budget is \$420,000. Changes affecting the approved budget or contractual commitments will require assessment and approval in accordance with the project's change-control and governance arrangements.

Detailed cost estimates, actual expenditure, forecasts, and approved budget changes will be maintained in the appropriate financial/project cost records rather than duplicated in this plan.

8. Resource Management

Project resources will be planned, assigned, and monitored to ensure that appropriate skills and capacity are available to support project delivery.

Resource management will include:

- identifying resource and skill requirements for planned project activities;
- assigning responsibilities based on project roles, technical expertise, and delivery needs;
- coordinating resource availability with the project schedule and sprint/delivery plans;
- monitoring resource capacity, workload, availability, and dependencies throughout delivery;
- identifying potential resource constraints or conflicts that may affect project commitments;
- coordinating adjustments to assignments or sequencing where practical; and
- escalating significant resource constraints that cannot be resolved within the project team.

The Project Manager will coordinate overall resource planning and monitor resource availability against the Integrated Project Schedule. Functional and technical leads will support allocation and management of resources within their respective areas.

Roles, responsibilities, and accountability will be maintained through the project organization structure and RACI Matrix. Detailed activity-level resource assignments and capacity assumptions will be maintained in the Integrated Project Schedule and supporting resource-planning records rather than duplicated in this plan.

Resource constraints that could materially affect scope, schedule, quality, or key project milestones will be assessed and managed through the appropriate risk, issue, schedule, and escalation processes.

9. Quality Management

Quality will be managed throughout the project lifecycle to ensure that project processes, deliverables, and the PeopleFirst Employee Self-Service Portal solution meet approved requirements, acceptance criteria, and applicable quality standards.

The project will apply a preventive, continuous, and risk-based quality approach, integrating quality activities into both iterative delivery and release-level validation.

Quality management will include:

- quality assurance activities such as requirements reviews, architecture/design reviews, development standards, peer/code reviews, and process/deliverable reviews;
- quality control through unit, functional, integration, regression, security, performance, and user acceptance testing as applicable;
- application of the Definition of Done during iterative delivery;
- requirements traceability from approved requirements through implementation, testing, defect resolution, and acceptance;
- identification, classification, resolution, retesting, and closure of defects;
- monitoring of relevant quality metrics and significant quality risks or non-conformances;
- application of quality gates and exit criteria aligned with existing project milestones and readiness reviews; and
- continuous improvement through retrospectives, defect trends, corrective/preventive actions, root-cause analysis, and lessons learned.

The Project Manager will coordinate overall quality governance and ensure that planned quality activities, evidence, risks, issues, and quality-gate status are appropriately monitored and escalated. QA, Technical, Security, Business, DevOps, Operations, and other stakeholders will remain responsible for quality activities and decisions within their respective areas.

Detailed quality standards, responsibilities, testing strategy, defect-management criteria, metrics, quality gates, release-readiness requirements, and quality evidence are defined in the approved Quality Management Plan.

10. Risk Management

Project risks will be identified, assessed, monitored, controlled, and communicated throughout the project lifecycle to reduce threats to project objectives and take advantage of relevant opportunities.

Risk management will include:

- identifying risks throughout planning and delivery;
- assessing risks based on probability, impact, and overall exposure;
- assigning risk owners and defining appropriate response actions;
- monitoring risk triggers, response actions, residual risks, and changes in exposure;
- identifying and managing emerging risks arising from scope, schedule, resources, quality, security, integrations, dependencies, and stakeholder activities;

- escalating significant risks where they exceed agreed tolerance or require management decision; and
- converting realized risks into issues and managing them through the appropriate issue-management process.

The Project Manager will coordinate the overall risk-management process and maintain visibility of project risk exposure. Risk owners will be responsible for monitoring assigned risks and implementing agreed response actions. Relevant stakeholders will contribute to risk identification, assessment, response planning, and escalation within their areas of responsibility.

Risks will be reviewed regularly as part of existing project monitoring and governance activities, with significant risks summarized through project status reporting. Risk information will be updated as project conditions change.

Detailed risk-management methodology, scoring criteria, risk thresholds, ownership, response strategies, review arrangements, and individual project risks will be maintained in the Risk Management Plan and Risk Register rather than duplicated in this plan.

11. Issue Management

Project issues will be identified, recorded, assessed, assigned, monitored, resolved, and escalated throughout the project lifecycle to minimize their impact on project objectives and delivery.

Issue management will include:

- recording identified issues with sufficient information to understand their impact and required action;
- assessing issues based on their impact, urgency, and effect on project objectives or commitments;
- assigning an appropriate owner and agreed resolution actions;
- monitoring issue status, target resolution dates, dependencies, and outstanding actions;
- escalating issues that cannot be resolved within the assigned owner's authority or required timeframe;
- assessing impacts on scope, schedule, cost, resources, quality, risks, dependencies, or acceptance; and
- closing issues once agreed resolution actions have been completed and the outcome has been verified where applicable.

The Project Manager will coordinate the issue-management process, monitor significant open issues, facilitate cross-functional resolution, and escalate matters requiring management attention or decision. Issue owners will be responsible for progressing assigned resolution actions and providing status updates.

Issues will be reviewed regularly through existing project monitoring and governance activities, with significant issues included in project status reporting.

Where issue resolution requires a change to an approved project baseline or commitment, the proposed change will be managed through the established change-control process. Where an issue creates

additional uncertainty or future exposure, related risks will also be identified and managed as appropriate.

Detailed issue records, ownership, actions, target dates, status, and resolution evidence will be maintained in the project Issue Log rather than duplicated in this plan.

12. Stakeholder Engagement

Stakeholder engagement will be managed throughout the project lifecycle to ensure that relevant stakeholders are appropriately involved in planning, decision-making, requirements clarification, reviews, testing, acceptance, deployment, and handover.

Stakeholder engagement management will include:

- identifying stakeholders and understanding their roles, interests, influence, expectations, and level of involvement;
- assessing stakeholder engagement needs and maintaining appropriate engagement throughout the project;
- involving relevant stakeholders in requirements, reviews, decisions, testing, and acceptance activities;
- monitoring stakeholder participation, feedback, concerns, and changes in engagement;
- addressing stakeholder concerns and resolving or escalating engagement issues where necessary;
- coordinating stakeholder involvement around key milestones, dependencies, quality gates, UAT, go-live, and handover; and
- updating stakeholder information and engagement approaches as project circumstances change.

The Project Manager will coordinate overall stakeholder engagement, supported by the Product Owner/Business Lead, Delivery Manager, Business Analyst, and other project stakeholders as appropriate.

Stakeholder engagement will be integrated with the project's communication and governance activities rather than managed as a separate parallel process. Communication methods, frequency, ownership, and escalation arrangements will be governed through the Communications Management Plan.

Detailed stakeholder identification, analysis, engagement requirements, and relevant actions will be maintained in the Stakeholder Register and associated project records rather than duplicated in this plan.

13. Communications Management

Project communications will be planned and managed to ensure that stakeholders receive relevant, accurate, and timely information appropriate to their roles, responsibilities, and decision-making needs.

Communications management will include:

- regular project status reporting covering progress, milestones, risks, issues, dependencies, decisions, and actions;
- coordination of project team and delivery activities;
- communication of significant schedule, scope, cost, quality, resource, and delivery concerns;

- stakeholder communications appropriate to their level of involvement and information needs;
- escalation of matters requiring management attention or decision;
- communication supporting testing, release readiness, deployment, handover, and closure; and
- maintenance of appropriate records of key decisions, actions, approvals, and project communications.

The Project Manager will coordinate overall project communications and ensure that significant information is communicated through the appropriate channels and governance mechanisms. Individual team members and functional leads will provide and communicate information within their respective areas of responsibility.

Communication effectiveness will be monitored throughout delivery, and the approach may be adjusted where stakeholder needs, project conditions, or delivery circumstances change.

Detailed communication requirements, stakeholder groups, communication methods, frequency, ownership, escalation paths, reporting arrangements, and communication tools are defined in the approved Communications Management Plan.

14. Requirements Management and Traceability

Requirements will be identified, analyzed, documented, reviewed, prioritized, validated, and maintained throughout the project lifecycle to ensure that the delivered solution remains aligned with approved business needs and project scope.

Requirements management will include:

- eliciting and documenting business, functional, integration, security, and non-functional requirements;
- reviewing requirements for clarity, feasibility, consistency, testability, and alignment with approved project scope;
- defining acceptance criteria where applicable;
- prioritizing and progressively refining requirements to support iterative delivery;
- maintaining traceability between requirements, development work items, testing, defects, and acceptance;
- managing requirement clarifications and identified gaps throughout design, development, testing, and UAT;
- obtaining appropriate stakeholder review and approval of requirements; and
- managing material changes to approved requirements through the established change-control process.

The Business Analyst will coordinate detailed requirements activities with the Product Owner/Business Lead, Project Manager, Solution Architect/Technical Lead, QA, Security, and other relevant stakeholders. The Product Owner/Business Lead will provide business clarification, prioritization, and acceptance as appropriate.

Requirements may be progressively elaborated during backlog refinement and iterative delivery, provided that such refinement remains within the approved project scope. Changes that materially affect approved scope or other project baselines will be subject to formal change control.

Detailed requirements, acceptance criteria, approvals, and traceability information will be maintained in the applicable requirements and business-analysis artifacts rather than duplicated in this plan.

15. Change Control

Changes to approved project scope, schedule, cost, requirements, solution, or other controlled baselines will be assessed and managed to ensure that their impacts are understood and appropriate approval is obtained before implementation.

Change management will include:

- identifying and documenting proposed changes;
- assessing the reason, benefit, urgency, and impact of the proposed change;
- evaluating impacts on scope, schedule, cost, resources, quality, risks, dependencies, technical solution, and contractual commitments as applicable;
- obtaining input from relevant business, technical, delivery, and other stakeholders;
- obtaining approval, rejection, or deferral from the appropriate decision-making authority;
- communicating approved changes to affected stakeholders;
- updating affected baselines, plans, requirements, schedules, and other project artifacts; and
- tracking approved changes through implementation and verification.

The Project Manager will coordinate the change-control process and ensure that material changes are appropriately assessed, documented, communicated, and governed. Relevant stakeholders will provide impact assessments and decisions within their respective areas of responsibility.

Routine clarification, backlog refinement, and delivery-level adjustments that remain within approved scope and do not materially affect approved baselines or commitments may be managed through normal project and Scrum delivery processes without formal change control.

Changes affecting approved scope, budget, contractual commitments, or key project baselines will require formal change control and approval by the appropriate authority.

Detailed change requests, impact assessments, decisions, approvals, and implementation status will be maintained in the Change Log/Change Request records rather than duplicated in this plan.

16. Configuration and Document Management

Project and solution artifacts will be managed to ensure that approved information and configuration items are appropriately identified, versioned, controlled, accessible, and traceable throughout the project lifecycle.

Configuration and document management will include:

- maintaining version control for applicable project, requirements, technical, testing, deployment, and operational artifacts;
- controlling source code and applicable application configuration through designated repositories and development tools;
- maintaining appropriate control over builds, releases, and environment-specific configurations;
- ensuring that approved changes are reflected in affected documents and configuration items;
- ensuring that current approved versions of relevant artifacts and solution components are used for testing, release, and deployment;
- maintaining appropriate document ownership, review, approval, and access controls; and
- retaining required project records and final approved artifacts in the appropriate project repositories.

Technical configuration items will be managed by the appropriate Development, Technical, and DevOps stakeholders. Project documentation will be maintained by the responsible document owners, with the Project Manager coordinating overall project-level document and configuration governance.

Detailed repository structures, source-control practices, build/versioning conventions, environment configurations, and document records will be maintained in the applicable project and technical tools rather than duplicated in this plan.

17. Technical and Integration Governance

Technical and integration activities will be governed to ensure that the solution remains aligned with approved architecture, technical requirements, enterprise standards, security requirements, and integration dependencies throughout delivery.

Technical and integration governance will include:

- reviewing solution architecture and significant technical design decisions;
- ensuring technical designs remain aligned with approved functional and non-functional requirements;
- defining and reviewing enterprise integration requirements, interfaces, data flows, connectivity, and dependencies;
- coordinating technical dependencies involving HRMS, identity/access management, email/notification services, network connectivity, and other applicable enterprise systems;
- identifying and resolving technical constraints, integration issues, and design conflicts;
- ensuring applicable security, performance, availability, and operational requirements are considered in technical decisions;
- validating integrations through appropriate technical and integration testing; and
- assessing significant technical changes for impact on architecture, integrations, scope, schedule, cost, quality, security, and operational readiness.

The Solution Architect and Technical Lead will provide technical leadership and governance within their respective areas, supported by Development, QA, Security, DevOps, and relevant client IT stakeholders. The Project Manager will coordinate technical dependencies, decisions, risks, issues, and escalations that affect overall project delivery.

Significant technical decisions and unresolved technical or integration concerns will be documented and escalated through the appropriate project governance mechanisms where required.

Detailed architecture, interface specifications, integration requirements, security requirements, and technical design information will be maintained in the applicable technical artifacts rather than duplicated in this plan.

18. Testing and Acceptance

Testing and acceptance activities will be planned and executed to verify that the solution meets approved requirements, acceptance criteria, technical specifications, and applicable non-functional requirements before production deployment.

Testing and acceptance will include:

- unit testing of applicable code components during development;
- functional and integration testing throughout iterative delivery;
- regression testing where required following changes and defect resolution;
- System Integration Testing (SIT) to validate integrated application behaviour, business workflows, enterprise interfaces, and dependencies;
- security and performance validation against applicable approved requirements and criteria;
- User Acceptance Testing (UAT) to validate business requirements, acceptance criteria, and fitness for intended business use;
- recording, classification, resolution, retesting, and closure or formal acceptance of identified defects;
- maintenance of appropriate traceability between requirements, test coverage, results, defects, and acceptance; and
- verification of applicable test exit and acceptance criteria before progression to subsequent stages.

QA will coordinate applicable test planning, execution, defect management, and test-status reporting, supported by Development and Technical teams. The Product Owner/Business stakeholders will coordinate and perform business validation and UAT, with project-team support. Security, DevOps, and other specialists will support applicable validation activities within their areas of responsibility.

Testing will occur progressively throughout iterative delivery rather than being deferred until development is complete. Following iterative development, the integrated solution will undergo the applicable release-level validation and acceptance activities.

SIT exit, UAT acceptance, and other applicable testing/readiness decisions will be aligned with existing project milestones and quality gates. Formal business acceptance will be obtained following successful completion of the applicable UAT acceptance criteria.

Detailed testing strategy, entry/exit criteria, quality requirements, defect-management approach, traceability, and quality gates are defined in the Quality Management Plan. Detailed test cases, execution results, defects, and acceptance evidence will be maintained in the appropriate testing and project records.

19. Release, Deployment and Transition

Release, deployment, and transition activities will be planned and coordinated to ensure that the solution is deployed to production in a controlled manner and transitioned effectively to operational support.

Release, deployment, and transition management will include:

- confirming completion of applicable testing, UAT, security, performance, and production-readiness activities;
- verifying that release-blocking defects are resolved and remaining defects, risks, and issues are appropriately assessed and accepted;
- confirming production environment, access, configuration, connectivity, and integration readiness;
- preparing and reviewing the release package, deployment procedures, and rollback/recovery arrangements;
- coordinating deployment activities, responsibilities, timing, dependencies, and stakeholder communications;
- validating the solution and critical integrations following production deployment;
- ensuring required technical, user, support, and operational documentation is available;
- completing required knowledge transfer and operational handover activities;
- confirming monitoring, support, incident-management, and escalation arrangements; and
- tracking and resolving or formally transferring outstanding post-deployment actions.

The Project Manager will coordinate overall release and transition activities with the Delivery Manager, Technical Team, DevOps, QA, Security, Product Owner/Business stakeholders, Operations, and other relevant stakeholders. Technical deployment activities will be performed by the appropriate technical and DevOps resources, while Operations will support production acceptance and transition to ongoing support.

The go-live decision will be aligned with the project's production-readiness milestone and quality gate. Production deployment will proceed only after applicable readiness criteria have been satisfied and the required approval has been obtained.

Following deployment, production validation and agreed transition/support activities will be completed before final operational handover and project closure.

Detailed deployment procedures, release checklists, rollback arrangements, production-validation evidence, support information, and handover records will be maintained in the applicable release and operational artifacts rather than duplicated in this plan.

20. Procurement / External Support

Procurement and external support will be managed where third-party products, services, licences, specialist expertise, or vendor support are required for successful project delivery.

Procurement and external-support activities will include:

- identifying external products, services, licences, or specialist support required by the project;

- defining applicable requirements, responsibilities, deliverables, timelines, and acceptance expectations;
- coordinating procurement or engagement activities through the appropriate organizational processes;
- monitoring external commitments, deliverables, dependencies, and agreed timelines;
- coordinating vendor or specialist activities with the project schedule and relevant technical activities;
- validating externally provided deliverables or services against agreed requirements where applicable;
- identifying and managing procurement/vendor-related risks, issues, and dependencies; and
- escalating significant commercial, contractual, technical, or delivery concerns through the appropriate governance channels.

The Project Manager will coordinate project-level dependencies involving external providers and ensure that their activities are appropriately reflected in project planning, monitoring, and reporting.

Procurement, commercial, technical, security, and other relevant stakeholders will retain responsibility for decisions and approvals within their respective areas of authority.

Any external commitment or change that materially affects approved project scope, schedule, cost, contractual commitments, or other baselines will be assessed and managed through the applicable change-control and organizational procurement processes.

Where no external procurement or vendor engagement is required, this management area will not introduce additional project processes or documentation.

21. Governance and Decision-Making

Project governance will provide clear accountability, oversight, decision-making authority, and escalation throughout the project lifecycle while enabling timely delivery.

Governance and decision-making will include:

- monitoring project performance against approved scope, schedule, cost, quality, and other applicable baselines;
- reviewing significant risks, issues, dependencies, changes, and delivery concerns;
- making routine project and delivery decisions at the appropriate level of authority;
- obtaining business, technical, security, quality, operational, or other specialist decisions from the accountable stakeholders where applicable;
- escalating matters that exceed delegated authority or agreed project tolerances;
- obtaining required decisions and approvals at key milestones, readiness reviews, quality gates, UAT, go-live, and project closure; and
- recording significant decisions, approvals, actions, and escalations in the appropriate project records.

The Project Manager will manage day-to-day project governance, coordinate cross-functional decision-making, facilitate resolution of project matters, and escalate decisions that exceed delegated authority. The Delivery Manager will provide delivery oversight and support significant escalations. The Sponsor,

Product Owner/Business Lead, and relevant technical or functional authorities will make decisions within their respective areas of accountability.

Decisions will be made at the lowest appropriate level of authority to support timely delivery. Matters affecting approved scope, budget, contractual commitments, key project baselines, significant business or technical risk, or production readiness will be escalated to the appropriate decision-making authority.

Existing project status reviews, delivery meetings, milestone/readiness reviews, quality gates, and escalation channels will be used for governance wherever practicable rather than establishing duplicate governance forums.

Significant governance decisions and approvals will be maintained in the appropriate project records to provide accountability and traceability.

22. Performance Monitoring and Reporting

Project performance will be monitored and reported throughout the project lifecycle to provide visibility of progress, identify variances and emerging concerns, and support timely corrective action and decision-making.

Performance monitoring and reporting will include:

- progress against the approved schedule, milestones, and planned deliverables;
- scope and requirements status, including significant changes;
- budget performance and forecast where applicable;
- resource availability and significant capacity constraints;
- quality and testing status, including significant defects and quality-gate readiness;
- key risks, issues, dependencies, and response/action status;
- change-request status and impact on approved baselines;
- stakeholder, technical, integration, and external dependencies affecting delivery;
- upcoming activities, milestones, and decisions requiring attention; and
- overall project status and areas requiring escalation or management action.

The Project Manager will coordinate project performance monitoring, consolidate information from relevant project and delivery sources, and communicate material status through the established project reporting and governance mechanisms. Activity owners and functional leads will provide timely and accurate progress information for their respective areas.

Project performance will be reviewed regularly against approved baselines and current forecasts. Significant variances or trends that threaten project objectives or key commitments will be investigated, with corrective or recovery actions identified and escalated where necessary.

Detailed performance information will remain in the applicable source artifacts and tools, including the Integrated Project Schedule, cost records, risk and issue logs, change records, testing/quality records, and delivery tools. Project status reporting will consolidate the material information required for stakeholder and management visibility rather than duplicate the underlying records.

Reporting frequency, audience, communication channels, ownership, and escalation arrangements will follow the Communications Management Plan.

23. Variance and Escalation Management

Project variances will be identified, assessed, and managed throughout the project lifecycle to ensure that deviations from approved baselines, plans, or agreed commitments are understood and addressed in a timely manner.

Variance and escalation management will include:

- monitoring actual performance against approved scope, schedule, cost, quality, and other applicable baselines or commitments;
- identifying significant deviations, adverse trends, and forecast impacts;
- assessing the cause, impact, urgency, and potential consequences of identified variances;
- determining appropriate corrective, recovery, or preventive actions;
- monitoring agreed actions and their effectiveness;
- escalating variances that cannot be resolved within the project team's authority or that materially threaten project objectives or key commitments; and
- initiating formal change control where resolution requires modification of an approved baseline.

The Project Manager will coordinate variance analysis, corrective actions, and escalation. Relevant activity owners and functional leads will support analysis and resolution within their areas of responsibility.

Variances will initially be managed at the lowest appropriate level. Significant matters affecting approved scope, schedule, budget, quality, contractual commitments, key milestones, business acceptance, or production readiness will be escalated through the established governance and communication channels.

Variance information, corrective actions, decisions, and significant escalations will be recorded in the appropriate existing project artifacts and reflected in project status reporting where material. Separate variance or escalation records will not be created where the information is already adequately maintained through schedule, cost, risk, issue, change, quality, or decision records.

24. Project Closure

Project closure will be performed in a controlled manner to confirm that agreed project deliverables and transition activities have been completed, outstanding matters have been appropriately addressed, and formal project closure has been achieved.

Project closure will include:

- confirming completion and acceptance of agreed project deliverables;
- confirming production deployment and completion of applicable post-deployment validation and transition activities;
- confirming completion of required documentation, knowledge transfer, and operational handover;

- obtaining required business, operational, and project acceptance/sign-off;
- reviewing outstanding defects, risks, issues, changes, dependencies, and actions and ensuring that they are resolved, accepted, or formally transferred to appropriate owners;
- reviewing project performance against approved scope, schedule, cost, quality, and success criteria;
- completing applicable financial, procurement, administrative, and resource-closure activities;
- capturing and reviewing lessons learned and improvement opportunities;
- archiving required project records and final versions of applicable artifacts; and
- obtaining formal approval to close the project.

The Project Manager will coordinate project-closure activities with the Sponsor, Delivery Manager, Product Owner/Business stakeholders, Operations, Technical Team, and other relevant stakeholders.

Project resources will be released following completion or formal transfer of their remaining responsibilities. Any residual operational items will be assigned to identified owners with appropriate supporting information before project closure.

A project closure report/checklist and applicable acceptance, handover, lessons-learned, and closure records will provide evidence that closure requirements have been satisfied.

25. Subsidiary Plans and Key Project Artifacts

Artifact / Plan	Purpose / Relationship to PMP
Project Charter	Authorizes the project and establishes high-level objectives, scope, budget, governance and authority.
Requirements Register / BA Baseline	Defines and controls business and solution requirements.
WBS / Scope Baseline	Structures approved project scope into manageable work packages.
Integrated Project Schedule	Establishes planned activities, milestones, dependencies and timing.
Cost Baseline / Cost Control Dashboard	Establishes approved cost plan and supports cost/performance monitoring.
RACI Matrix / Resource Loading	Defines project roles and accountability and supports resource assignment and capacity monitoring.
Stakeholder Register	Records stakeholder identification and analysis.
Risk Management Plan	Defines project risk-management methodology and governance.
Risk Register	Maintains the living record of identified project risks.
Communications Management Plan	Defines project communication and reporting requirements.
Quality Management Plan	Defines quality standards, assurance, control, testing and acceptance governance.
Architecture / NFR / Integration / Security	Provide detailed technical governance and

Artifact / Plan	Purpose / Relationship to PMP
Specifications	solution requirements.
Issue Log	Maintains identified project issues, ownership, actions, target dates and resolution status.
Change Log / Change Request Records	Maintains material change requests, impact assessments, decisions, approvals and implementation status.
Assumptions and Dependencies Log	Maintains significant assumptions and dependencies, ownership, status, required dates and actions.

26. Assumptions, Constraints and Dependencies

Project assumptions, constraints, and dependencies will be identified, documented, monitored, and reviewed throughout the project lifecycle because changes to these conditions may affect project delivery.

Assumptions, constraints, and dependencies will include, as applicable:

- availability and timely participation of key business, technical, security, and operational stakeholders;
- availability of required project resources and specialist skills;
- timely availability of development, test/SIT, UAT/staging, and production environments;
- availability of required system access, network connectivity, integration endpoints, and enterprise-system support;
- availability of suitable test data and client-controlled data where required;
- dependencies on HRMS, identity/access management, email/notification services, and other enterprise systems;
- approved project scope, schedule, budget, resource, technical, and organizational constraints; and
- dependencies on client teams, external support, approvals, decisions, and other activities outside the direct control of the project team.

The Project Manager will coordinate the monitoring of significant assumptions, constraints, and dependencies with the relevant owners. Changes or failures in underlying assumptions and dependencies will be assessed for impact on scope, schedule, cost, quality, resources, risks, and project commitments.

Where an assumption proves invalid or a dependency or constraint threatens delivery, the resulting impact will be managed through the appropriate risk, issue, schedule, change, or escalation process.

Detailed assumptions and dependencies, including ownership, status, required dates, impacts, and actions, will be maintained in the project's Assumptions and Dependencies Log and relevant project artifacts rather than duplicated in this plan.

27. Approval

Role	Name	Approval / Date
Prepared By	Karthick BK	Aug 31, 2026
Reviewed By	Ananya Rao	Aug 31, 2026
Approved By	Sarah Mitchell	Aug 31, 2026